CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PRIVATE CHEF IN THE AI ERA

The households hiring private chefs are real and rich. The door is guarded by agencies that require years of private-household experience — before your first household job.

★ TL;DR — NO. There is no BLS occupation called Private Chef; its own subcategory, Cooks, Private Household, pays □$47,944 a year ($23.05/hr, BLS, May 2025) — so the old card's $75K was +56% over the occupation itself. Worse, the seat is agency-gated: placement agencies require 3–5+ years of private-household experience (one elite tier: 8–10 years) on top of 5+ years of professional cooking. A beginner's actual 2027 job is restaurant cook at $17.98/hr. The roadmap below routes those years toward seats that are open. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$48K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

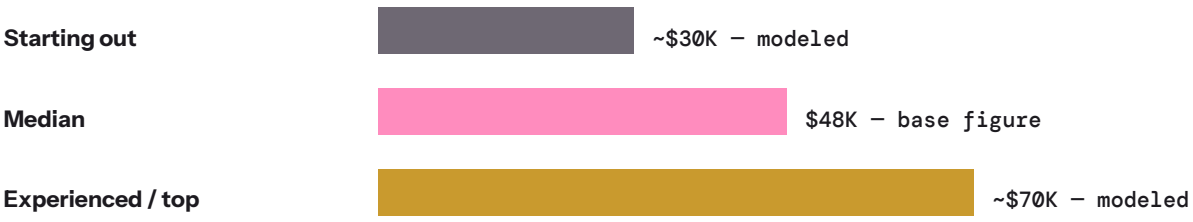
- Fails as a start because: every door into the seat is gated behind experience the beginner cannot have yet — 5+ years of professional cooking (the Chefs anchor), then 3–5+ years inside private households (the agencies).

- The pay error: agency figures of $100–300K describe the experienced ultra-high-net-worth segment, not a median; the occupation's own BLS median is □$48K.

- Not an AI story: nothing cooks, shops or serves in a home by machine. The entry taxes are gatekeeping and platform tolls — Cozymeal takes 20–30% of bookings, Yhangry 20%.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Private Chef is a ~$48K median (compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PRIVATE CHEF ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Plan and cook all meals inside one household, to its tastes and rules
- ✓ Shop, stock and manage the household kitchen and pantry budget
- ✓ Serve at table and cover household events and guests
- ✓ Run the role with total discretion — you see everything, you say nothing

Think: a one-person restaurant whose only customers are the family that employs you — and whose dining room you may never discuss.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Nothing at the core of the work. Gig platforms (Cozymeal, Yhangry) intermediate one-off private-dining bookings and take 20–30% — a toll on access, not automation of the cooking.	Reading one family's tastes, dietary rules and moods; improvising in an unfamiliar kitchen; discretion. The entire product is trust plus craft, delivered in person.

⚠ **Agency requirements are the wall, stated plainly: Morgan & Mallet asks at least four (usually five) years of professional cooking with at least one year in a private household or fine dining; IVY Chef Agency typically requires 3–5 years in private households; Private Chefs Inc.'s elite tier starts at 8–10 years. There is no beginner version of this seat to apply for.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ The destination itself is genuinely good: one employer, high trust, top-of-market pay at the experienced end ✓ The subcategory is growing modestly (+5%, BLS) and the work cannot be automated ✓ Every year of cooking and catering experience moves you closer to the gate	✗ You cannot start here in 2027 — full stop ✗ The card's old $75K overshot even the occupation's own median by 56% ✗ Platform gigs front you the ingredient costs and take 20–30% off the top

Good fit? You're playing a long game: you'll cook professionally for years and treat households as the final seat, not the first.

Bad fit? You need the private-chef income or lifestyle in year one, or you're counting on gig platforms as the entry ramp.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO Caterer	DOOR B — PIVOT TO Restaurant Manager
Catering is the open version of the same craft: nobody gatekeeps the title, companies hire beginners at the cook layer immediately, and a permitted own business is legally openable in year one — the permit stack (food-facility permit, commissary agreement, plan review) is the real gate, and it is passable. Labelled anchor: Food Service Managers median $69,390 (BLS, May 2025), +6%, ~38,800 openings a year. Event work also builds exactly the references and menus household agencies later ask for. First move: one full season cooking for a catering company.	Food Service Managers: median $69,390, +6%, ~38,800 openings a year, formal requirement a high school diploma plus less than 5 years of related experience; the ladder is floor ~$35K → supervisor $45,370 → manager $69,390. It pays a salary while your cooking years accumulate — the same years the private-chef gate will eventually count. First move: join a well-run group as a cook and declare the supervisor track early.

Smart move: Collect references like currency. Household hiring runs on named references from employers and event clients — every catering client and kitchen manager who will vouch for you is a brick in the only bridge over the agency gate.
Where you land after: You land earning in open seats now — catering or restaurant management at the $69K anchor — with the private-household seat kept as the year-5+ destination it actually is.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
READ THE	START AS	PICK YOUR	BUILD THE	USE PLATFORMS	APPLY TO

STEP 1 — Read the real numbers FREE · TODAY

- Read the agency requirements yourself (Morgan & Mallet, IVY, Private Chefs Inc.): years of household experience, before hiring
- Read the BLS Cooks page: private-household median $23.05/hr □ $47,944 — not $75K

STEP 2 — Start as a cook — deliberately

WEEKS 1-4

- Take cook work where the food is closest to household cooking: fine dining, boutique catering, chef-driven small kitchens
- Skip any programme that promises household placement without the experience the agencies demand

STEP 3 — Pick your door

MONTH 2

- Door A if you want your own clients fastest: catering events build the reference book agencies respect
- Door B if you want salary stability while the years accumulate: the manager ladder pays throughout

STEP 4 — Build the household-grade record

MONTHS 2-12

- Keep menus, photos and named references from every event and employer
- Learn dietary, kosher/halal, allergy and etiquette service — the household differentiators

STEP 5 — Use platforms as seasoning, not the meal

ONGOING

- Take occasional Cozymeal/Yhangry events for references — pricing in their 20–30% commission and your ingredient costs
- Never let platform gigs substitute for the employed years the agencies count

STEP 6 — Apply to the gate when you can pass it

YEAR 3-5

- With 3+ years of cooking plus event/household-adjacent references, register with two agencies
- Target trial and part-time household seats first — they are the recognised breach in the wall

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: read one agency's requirements page end to end — then the BLS private-household wage line.
- □ Days 1–30: cook applications out to fine-dining and catering employers; door chosen.
- □ Days 31–60: cooking employed; reference book started from day one.
- □ Days 61–90: first event or fine-dining service credits collected, with names attached.
- □ Day 90: you're accumulating the exact years the gate counts — in seats that are open today.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

· Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test

· Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ EARN THE HOUSE. DON'T APPLY FOR IT EARLY. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.